

ESADE Master's Finance Club

Fintech in October 2026: scale over disruption



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Fintech's biggest stories this month were about scale, licences and listings rather than disruption. We went through October's deals and news from FinTech Futures, Bloomberg, the FT and others, and these are the four trends that stood out to us.

$60bn
Ramp's reported pre-money valuation
Behind Fintech, 13 Oct 2026

$7bn
IPO valuation of both Mynt (GCash) and Airtel Money
FinTech Futures, 9 Oct 2026

11.2x
oversubscription of MNT-Halan's institutional tranche
Billionaires Africa, 15 Oct 2026

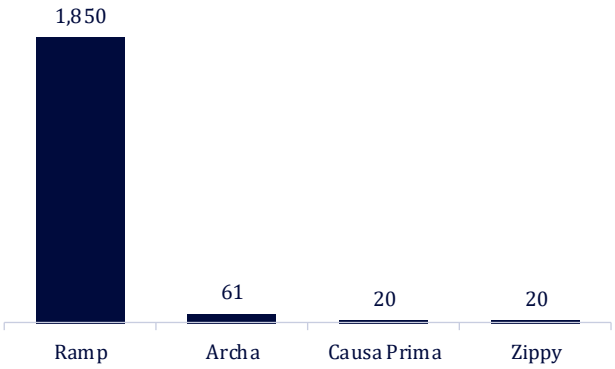
5,000
jobs Barclays is cutting this year, about 5% of its staff
Reuters, 22 Oct 2026

1 Why is so much money going to so few fintechs?

Ramp, a US corporate card and expense software company, reportedly raised $1.85bn at a $60bn pre-money valuation (the company's value before the new money comes in). That one round is more than three times the $541m raised across 15 fintech deals in a single week at the start of October (our calculation).

Further down, rounds are small: Archa raised $61m, mostly as debt, while Causa Prima and Zippy raised $20m each. Investors are concentrating on proven B2B revenue, where switching costs tend to be higher than with consumers.

Selected fintech rounds in October 2026, $m



Source: Behind Fintech, 13 Oct 2026; FinTech Global, 14 Oct 2026.

Key insight Capital is concentrating in a handful of proven B2B platforms; for everyone else, rounds are small and often part debt.

Stablecoins move closer to banking, but not yet at scale

Rain, stablecoin payments — **9 Oct 2026**

Filed with the US OCC to set up Rain National Trust Bank, a federal trust bank for its stablecoin payments business. The charter still needs regulatory approval.

Bakkt and Thredd — **13 Oct 2026**

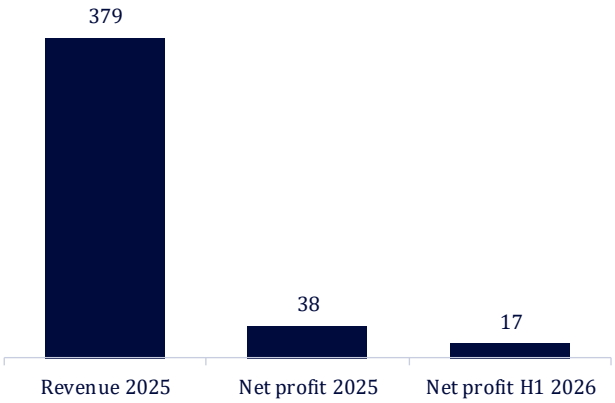
Bakkt picked card processor Thredd to launch a US credit card programme that settles in stablecoins. A first proof of concept is planned for the first half of 2027.

2 Why are the biggest fintech listings happening outside the US?

The fintech IPO window is reopening, but not on Wall Street. Mynt, owner of the Philippine wallet GCash, priced its IPO at about $7bn to raise roughly $845m. Airtel Money priced its London listing at $7bn, and Egypt's MNT-Halan drew bids from more than 300 investors in over ten countries before its 20 October Cairo debut.

MNT-Halan is profitable, earning $38m on $379m of revenue in 2025. In markets where bank accounts are less common, the phone wallet became the bank, and investors are now pricing that scale.

MNT-Halan revenue and net profit, $m



Source: Billionaires.Africa, 15 Oct 2026 (company figures).

$7bn
Mynt (GCash) IPO valuation, Manila

$7bn
Airtel Money listing valuation, London

~$845m
Mynt's targeted raise (PHP 53bn)

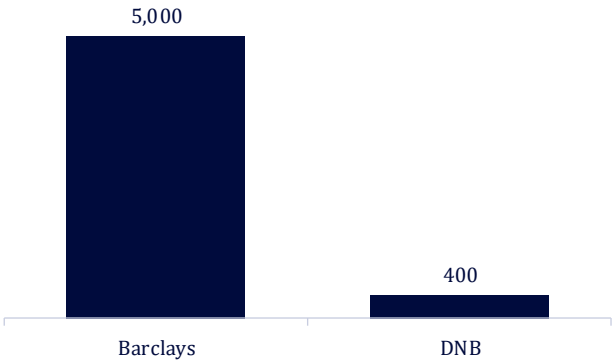
Key insight Mobile money is now a listed asset class, but each IPO is still a bet on a single country and its regulator.

3 Is AI starting to replace bank jobs?

For years AI in banking meant pilots and chatbots. In October it meant job cuts. Barclays will cut about 5,000 jobs this year, around 5% of its staff, mostly in operations and support roles, while reporting a 12% rise in quarterly profit to £2.3bn. HSBC reportedly plans to cut about 70% of its UK wealth advisers, and Norway's DNB announced 400 job cuts.

Barclays' CEO called AI "the icing on the cake, not the cake": the savings rest on years of technology investment. Whether service quality and client trust hold is still untested.

AI-linked job cuts announced in October 2026, roles



Source: Reuters, 22 Oct 2026; FinTech Futures, 9 Oct 2026.

Key insight Barclays cut jobs while profit rose 12%: AI's first visible impact in banking is on costs, not new revenue.

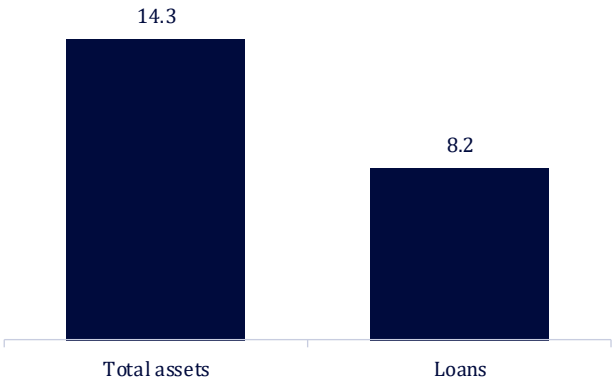
4 How are traditional banks fighting back?

By buying and building at the same time. Crédit Agricole agreed to acquire 100% of Germany's IKB Deutsche Industriebank from Lone Star Funds. IKB lends to the Mittelstand (Germany's mid-sized companies) and had €14.3bn of assets and €8.2bn of loans at the end of 2025. Closing is expected by end-June 2027.

Days earlier the group announced Crédit Agricole Deutschland, a digital-first retail bank offering current accounts, Visa cards and savings from the end of October, with lending and investments planned from 2027.

Banks also partner with the fintechs they compete with: BBVA and Santander built their blockchain loan platform with fintech ioBuilders (see Spain corner).

IKB Deutsche Industriebank at end-2025, €bn



Source: Behind Fintech, 13 Oct 2026.

Key insight Incumbents do not need to out-innovate fintechs: they can buy customers, build digital products on top and partner with fintechs where it is faster.

Deals worth a closer look

Deal	Terms as announced	Status
Ramp (US), Oct 2026. Thrive Capital and Dragoneer lead; Founders Fund joins	About $1.85bn at a $60bn pre-money valuation; implied dilution ~3% (our calculation)	Reported by Bloomberg
IKB (Germany), Oct 2026. Crédit Agricole buys from Lone Star Funds	100% stake in a Mittelstand lender with €14.3bn of assets	Closing expected by end-June 2027
Mynt / GCash (Philippines), Oct 2026. Initial public offering	PHP 53bn (about $845m) from about 8.03bn shares; valuation about $7bn	Priced; offer opened to the public

What to watch next

Will Ramp's private $60bn delay the IPOs of Revolut, Plaid and Kraken?

Will October's emerging-market fintech IPOs hold their value after listing?

Will regulators give stablecoin firms like Rain bank-style charters?

How to read this pdf. Figures are quoted as published; "our calculation" marks numbers we worked out ourselves and "~" marks approximations. Several figures come from press reports and have not been confirmed by the companies. For educational purposes only and not investment advice.

Sources. Behind Fintech, Daily (13 Oct 2026, citing Bloomberg); FinTech Futures, Top five news stories of the week (9 Oct 2026, citing the Financial Times and the Wall Street Journal); FinTech Global, Editor's picks (14 Oct 2026) and weekly deal round-up (2 Oct 2026); The Fintech Times (14 Oct 2026); PYMNTS, Latest in Fintech (13 Oct 2026); Billionaires.Africa, MNT-Halan IPO (15 Oct 2026); Reuters, Barclays to slash 5,000 jobs (22 Oct 2026).

5 Q3 earnings: are the payment giants still growing?

Company	Reported	Key numbers	Read-across
PayPal (US)	27 Oct 2026	Revenue $8.58bn, +2% (consensus $8.71bn); adj. EPS $1.45 vs $1.31 expected; TPV $487bn, +6%	Profit beat, revenue miss; full-year adj. EPS guidance raised to about $5.60
American Express (US)	23 Oct 2026	Adj. EPS $4.68 vs $4.51 expected; billed business $454bn, +8%	Beat and raise: full-year adj. EPS guidance now $17.60 to $17.90
Visa (US)	27 Oct 2026	Net revenue $12.1bn, +13%; non-GAAP EPS $3.48, +17%; payments volume +9%, cross-border +14% (constant dollar)	Fiscal Q4 (July to Sept): double-digit growth; quarterly dividend raised 16%
Robinhood (US)	27 Oct 2026	Revenue $1.42bn, +12%; net income $476m, −14%; diluted EPS $0.51; platform assets $396bn, +19%	Revenue and assets grew, but profit fell year on year

Key insight Visa and Amex keep growing, but PayPal shows growth is the hard part: payment volume rose 6% while revenue rose only 2%.

6 Spain corner: what happened closer to home?

ID Finance, Barcelona — **13 Oct 2026**

Raised €545m in debt and equity, one of the largest rounds ever for a Spanish fintech, to grow its lending app Plazo and launch Turrón, a buy-now-pay-later product. It reported €243m of revenue in 2025.

Iberdrola, BBVA and Santander — **15 Oct 2026**

Closed a €150m syndicated loan managed end to end on a blockchain platform built by ioBuilders with both banks, from disbursement and interest to repayments. The banks call it the first of its kind.

7 Startup to watch: Causa Prima

$20m
seed round led by Base10 Partners

$30m
raised in total, incl. a $10m pre-seed

25
employees

Madrid
and Munich offices; New York next

What it does AI agents sit on both sides of a B2B invoice, one for the buyer's payables team and one for the supplier's receivables, and negotiate approvals and early payment directly.

How it makes money It takes a cut each time its agents secure an early payment.

Why it matters B2B payments are worth roughly $98tn a year, and invoice processing takes more than eight days on average (Ardent Partners). Spanish VC Kfund is an investor.

The risk It is a network business: the agents only work if both buyer and supplier sign up, which a seed-stage company has to win against established payables software.

New to finance? Pre-money valuation is a company's value before new investment; an IPO is a company's first sale of shares on a stock exchange; a stablecoin is a digital token pegged to a currency such as the dollar; adjusted EPS is profit per share excluding one-off items; TPV is the total value of payments a company processes.

Sources. PayPal, Visa and Robinhood earnings releases (27 Oct 2026) and American Express earnings release (23 Oct 2026); consensus estimates via Investing.com and 24/7 Wall St; El Español, ID Finance funding round (13 Oct 2026); Santander press release (15 Oct 2026); Dealroom and FinTech Global, Causa Prima seed round (13-14 Oct 2026). Figures are quoted as published.